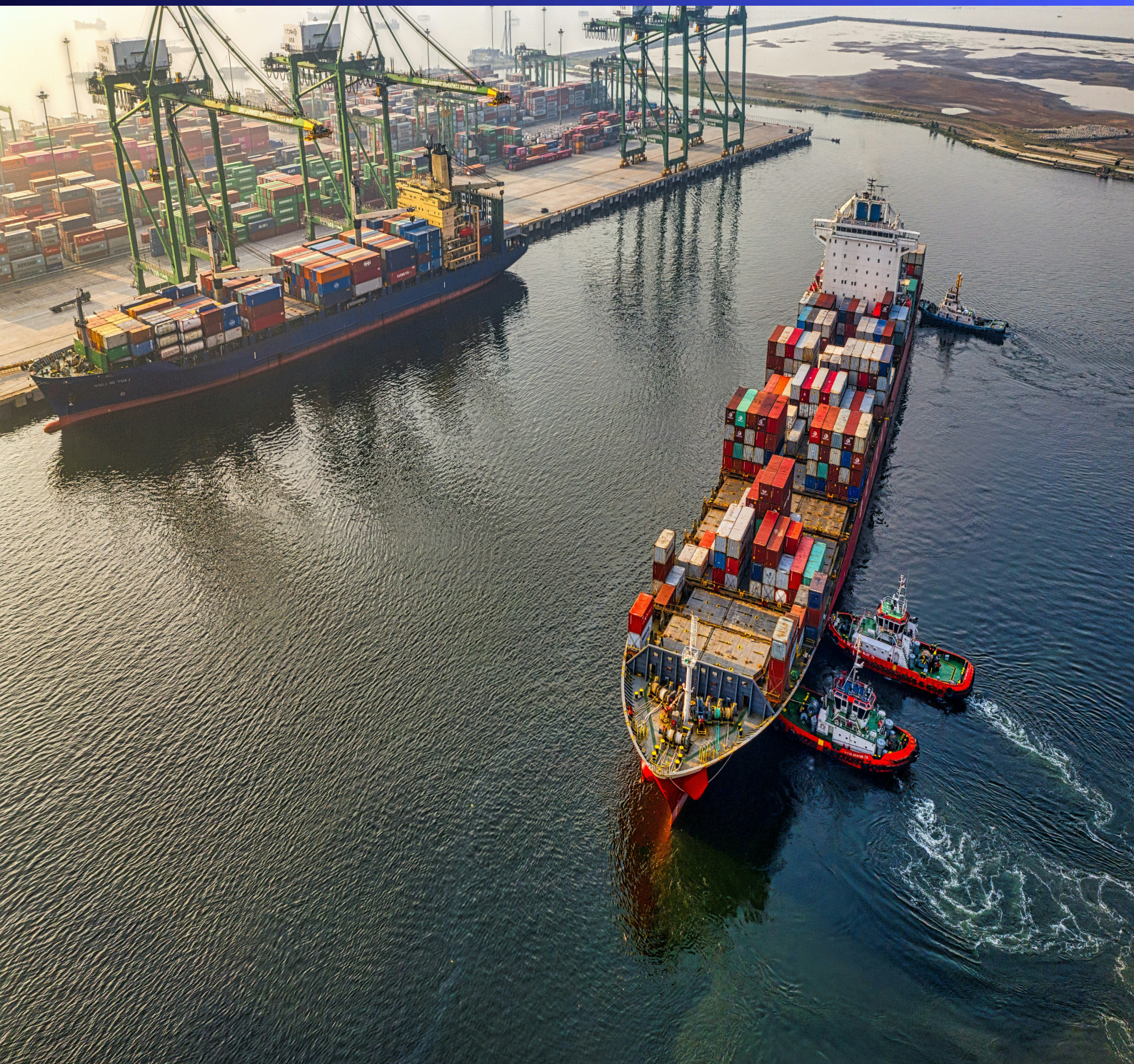




SHIPPING WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 26 MAY 2026 - 1 JUNE 2026

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The week was dominated by the report that "Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says". Maritime reporting was centred on chokepoint risk, vessel attack and piracy / armed robbery. Iran saw the most activity, with less from Singapore and UAE. The most serious reached high.

MARITIME INTELLIGENCE

MARITIME RISK LEVEL

L4 · High

CONFIRMED INCIDENTS · 7D

2

CHOKEPOINTS AFFECTED

0 / 7

BUSINESS IMPACT

3

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

Maritime risk is High. A confirmed kinetic attack on shipping this week. The main commercial exposure is war-risk insurance premium pressure and chartering / fixture caution.

CHOKEPOINT CARDS

Strait of Hormuz - L1 Insignificant

- Confirmed (7d): 0
- Last incident: None in window
- Movement: Tracked · 130 AIS-dark
- Business impact: No material impact
- Confidence: Low

Bab el-Mandeb - L1 Insignificant

- Confirmed (7d): 0
- Last incident: None in window
- Movement: Movement data unavailable
- Business impact: No material impact
- Confidence: Low

Red Sea - L1 Insignificant

- Confirmed (7d): 0
- Last incident: None in window
- Movement: Tracked · 1 AIS-dark
- Business impact: No material impact
- Confidence: Low

Suez Canal - L1 Insignificant

- Confirmed (7d): 0
- Last incident: None in window
- Movement: 27 vessels tracked · 4 in / 2 out · 17 anchored · 35 AIS-dark
- Business impact: No material impact
- Confidence: Low

Gulf of Aden - L1 Insignificant

- Confirmed (7d): 0
- Last incident: None in window
- Movement: Movement data unavailable
- Business impact: No material impact
- Confidence: Low

Singapore Strait - L1 Insignificant

- Confirmed (7d): 0
- Last incident: None in window
- Movement: 60 vessels tracked · 9 in / 8 out · 8 tankers · 35 anchored · 131 AIS-dark
- Business impact: No material impact
- Confidence: Low

Malacca Strait - L1 Insignificant

- Confirmed (7d): 0
- Last incident: None in window
- Movement: Tracked · 202 AIS-dark

- Business impact: No material impact
- Confidence: Low

CONFIRMED MARITIME INCIDENTS

- 29 May - Attack · High: HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman
- 28 May - Piracy / armed robbery · High: Two incidents of armed robbery against ships in Asia from 2-8 June

MARITIME CONTEXT - VESSEL MOVEMENT (AIS)

- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 202 AIS-dark
- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 207 AIS-dark
- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 209 AIS-dark
- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 209 AIS-dark
- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 222 AIS-dark
- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 224 AIS-dark
- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 225 AIS-dark
- Malacca Strait - Tracked · 228 AIS-dark

Vessel movement is context only - it never counts as an incident and never raises the risk level on its own.

POLESTAR VIEW

A confirmed kinetic attack on shipping this week.

- Confirmed kinetic activity against shipping this week.
- Piracy or armed-robbery activity reported against vessels.
- AIS dark or gap reporting noted at Malacca Strait - an indicator only, not proof of intent.

Business impact: War-risk insurance premium pressure; Chartering / fixture caution; Crew vigilance advised.

Confidence: High.

Watch next:

- ## RED SEA DIRECTIONAL FLOW

Bab el-Mandeb SOUTH GATE

Suez Canal NORTH GATE

Directional flow is the heading split of each live AIS sample (course relative to the gateway, not a count of completed transits). Vessel movement is contextualized - it never counts as an incident and never raises the risk level on its own.

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD

26 May - 1 Jun 2026

CONFIRMED INCIDENTS

5

HIGHEST SEVERITY

High

MAIN AFFECTED CHOKEPOINT

Strait of Hormuz

2 records

VESSEL ATTACKS / SEIZURES

2

PIRACY / ARMED ROBBERY

2

Latest: 28 May 2026

LATEST SIGNIFICANT INCIDENT

29 May 2026

HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman

CHOKEPOINT / ROUTE READ

The busiest route this week is Strait of Hormuz, where the most serious incident reached high. The development driving the picture this week is the report that "Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says".

This week, reporting pointed specifically to transit problems, diversions or advisory pressure - a closer view of what shippers actually faced.

Keep an eye on new naval advisories for Strait of Hormuz, any changes to war-risk insurance and what operators say about rerouting. These are the early warning signs of escalation; freight rates follow a few days later.

CHOKEPOINT / ROUTE	RECORDS	SEVERITY	LATEST	OPERATIONAL READ
Strait of Hormuz	2	HIGH	27 May 2026	The standout here this week was "Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says", with further events reported alongside it.
Gulf of Oman	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.
Arabian / Persian Gulf	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.
Red Sea	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.
Bab el-Mandeb	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.
Suez Canal	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.
Gulf of Aden	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.
Singapore Strait	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.
Malacca Strait	0	-	-	Quiet this week, with little reported here.

VESSEL THREAT AND PIRACY READ

Threats to ships were reported recently, including attacks and seizures rather than just lower-level boardings or approaches. The standout was "HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman". Piracy and armed robbery were also reported over the same period, with "Two incidents of armed robbery against ships in Asia from 2-8 June" the clearest case.

Keep an eye on maritime advisories, naval statements and any change in war-risk or insurance costs on affected routes. These are the clearest early signs of whether attacks are picking up or easing.

VESSEL ATTACKS (26 MAY - 1 JUN 2026)

DATE	ACTOR	TITLE	SEVERITY
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DATE	ACTOR	TITLE	SEVERITY
29 May 2026	Attack	HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman	HIGH
27 May 2026	Attack	Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says	HIGH

PIRACY AND ARMED ROBBERY (26 MAY - 1 JUN 2026)

DATE	ACTOR	TITLE	SEVERITY
28 May 2026	Armed robbery	Two incidents of armed robbery against ships in Asia from 2-8 June	HIGH
26 May 2026	Armed robbery	ReCAAP ISC: One incident of armed robbery 19-25 May	HIGH

MARITIME SECURITY (ICC CCS / IMB)

The ICC International Maritime Bureau recorded no piracy or armed-robbery activity for this scope in the current year. Maritime security is a standalone reference layer and is never added to incident totals.

No piracy or armed-robbery activity recorded for this period by the ICC CCS / IMB Piracy Reporting Centre.

COMMERCIAL IMPACT ON SHIPPING

No port, freight, insurance or commercial shipping disruption was reported this week. General market news - new ship orders, vessel sales, fleet finance, earnings, share-price moves - is deliberately left out of this section, so a quiet week here means real disruption was genuinely low rather than simply unreported.

Keep an eye on new port advisories, schedule delays at the major container and tanker hubs, and any insurance changes tied to specific routes. These are the next signs that commercial pressure is building.

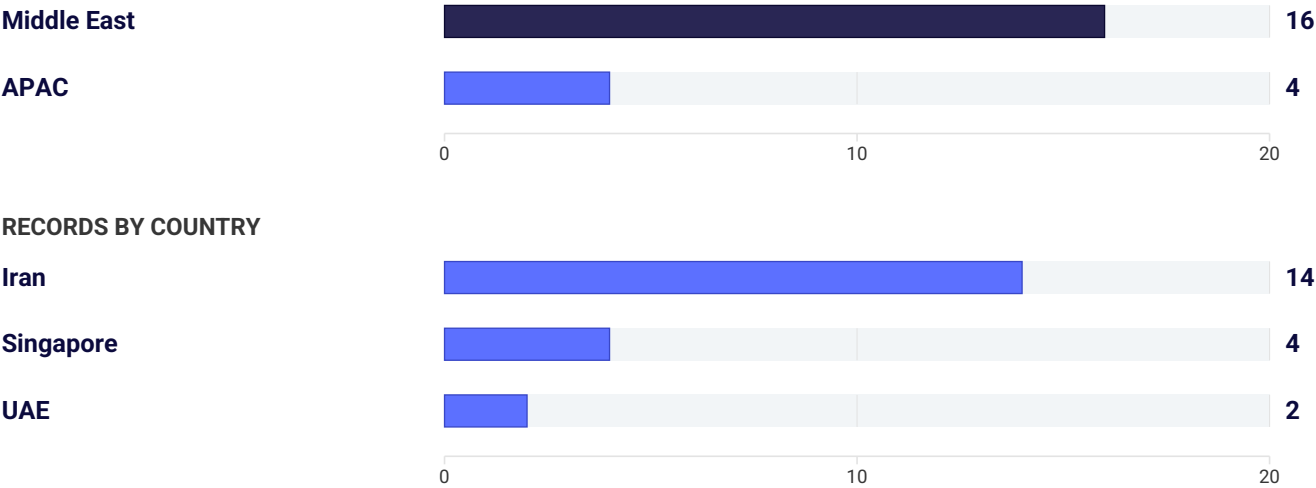
No port, freight, insurance or commercial-shipping disruption records in the weekly window.

REGIONAL AND COUNTRY VIEW

This week, Middle East saw the larger share of activity, ahead of APAC. By country, the most activity this week was in Iran, Singapore and UAE. These country figures are a rough guide only: a large share of reports could not be tied to a specific country, so country-level conclusions should be treated with caution.

Some reports could not be tied to a specific country and are left off the country chart to keep it accurate.

RECORDS BY REGION



WHAT MATTERS

The main pressure point this week is Strait of Hormuz. That matters for route planning, because each new warning makes transit times less predictable and feeds straight into ship scheduling and fuel planning for any company moving cargo through the region.

Attacks on ships remain the biggest risk, with vessel attacks, seizures, and piracy or armed robbery all reported recently (26 May - 1 Jun 2026). Any company sailing through the affected routes should be reviewing where crews are changed over, its war-risk and insurance costs, and the point at which its security advisers would recommend taking a different route.

By region, most activity this week was in Middle East; the breakdown by country is shown in the chart below.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Review ship scheduling, the order of port calls and fuel planning against the latest advisories for Strait of Hormuz.
- Assess war-risk and insurance exposure now - premium changes usually follow a week or two after the activity picks up.
- Line up alternative routes and the option to skip port calls on affected services; brief commercial teams on the risk of delays and added costs.
- Re-check where crews are changed over on voyages through the affected routes, and move to safer ports where possible.
- Confirm naval-escort or convoy options with security advisers for the highest-risk routes.

- Add flexibility clauses to near-term shipping contracts - a single port closure or war-risk change can push surcharges across a route within days.

WATCH NEXT

- New naval and maritime advisories on Strait of Hormuz: the earliest sign of where pressure is building.
- UKMTO, IMB and coalition-force bulletins: these move ahead of headline freight rates.
- War-risk and insurance premium changes on affected routes: the clearest confirmation that the activity is now hitting costs.
- Decisions by operators to divert or skip a port call: a prompt to review schedule reliability and delay costs.
- A step-up in naval escorts or convoys: a sign that security advisers are taking the threat more seriously.
- Crew-change advisories and flag-state guidance updates: a reason to re-check crewing plans on voyages through the area.
- War-risk insurance being extended to nearby waters: the clearest sign the danger zone is widening, not easing.

POLESTAR VIEW

Strait of Hormuz remains the main pressure point for shipping, and that is where the underlying risk continues to sit, no matter how busy or quiet a given week looks. The threat to ships - recent attacks, seizures, and piracy or armed robbery - still matters. A quiet spell in this region is normal, not a sign things have improved, so it is better read as a gap in reporting than as a lasting easing.

Operators should treat the current situation as a matter of route planning, insurance and keeping an eye on advisories rather than a wholesale shutdown of the region's shipping. The practical levers are war-risk and insurance reviews, where crews are changed over on voyages through Strait of Hormuz, and the port-call decisions that follow fresh advisories - not any expectation that the whole region will grind to a halt.

RELATED INCIDENTS

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
29 May 2026	Vessel attack	HMS Lancaster first to respond after suspected Iranian drone attack on tanker off Oman Vessel attack, reported 29 May 2026, assessed at High severity.	HIGH

DATE	ISSUE	TITLE	SEVERITY
27 May 2026	Vessel attack	Iranian missile likely involved in attack on ship in Strait of Hormuz, South Korea says Vessel attack, reported 27 May 2026, assessed at High severity.	HIGH
28 May 2026	Piracy / armed robbery	Two incidents of armed robbery against ships in Asia from 2-8 June Piracy / armed robbery, reported 28 May 2026, assessed at High severity.	HIGH

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